

We reached out and said that Pega people get paid more; so anybody who has heard of Pega and wants to join the ecosystem can be a part of this session. The session was geared towards bringing people who don't know what Pega is all about and teaching them about us. Participants actually got to build a live application in the session. It was pretty well received. Also, we participate in various industry conferences and try and be active within the community to let people know what we are doing.

Q You just mentioned how open source technologies have evolved over the years. How much of the development process in Pega involves open source technologies?

We use quite a lot of open source technologies like XSLT transformation. One of the things to do before releasing a product is to make sure that all of the licensing is correct. We use scanner software to do that. We would also like to contribute more to open source. It's something we have never really engaged in as a company in the past, but many of our engineers contribute to open source. One of the things that we are looking forward to doing in the coming years, as a company, is probably engage much more in open source.

Q Do you see open source technologies evolving and overtaking proprietary development processes, because of trends like SMAC?

It's going to be a very big thing. There are enough interesting models on open source which make it worthwhile. When a company commercialises an open source version of software, the commercial version is generally inexpensive enough for us to find it attractive. So we use Linux, Postgres and OpenStack, which are open source projects but there are commercial companies that have versions of those technologies. This duality model is really going to drive things forward -- maybe much faster than in the past, as there is some reluctance in taking up entirely open source modules. People will take individual modules and plug them in to their model as, in worst case scenarios, they can fix it themselves.

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Q The Indian government is focusing a lot on setting up manufacturing companies in India, which 'Make in India'. How do you view the policies of the new Indian government?

I love that idea because we make most of everything in India. The IT minister today was talking about what the government of Telangana is doing—it wants to invest in technology with a programme called Digital India. I think this is a tremendous programme. India is important to us as a market, as it is growing so rapidly with so many people; the standard of living is increasing. We don't have many customers in India though. Vodafone India is a customer of ours, which does all its outbound marketing using Pega technology, through which we are directly touching the Indian customers.

The other one is PayPal, which also has a large customer base in India. We have our technologies being used by companies operating in India. But there is a much bigger opportunity here. India is not a sales market for us yet, but we keep looking at it. One opportunity that we see is to work with the state governments or the Indian government on some sort of initiatives. If it has a social benefit and if we find the right application, we could do it as a social outreach activity. That would be an interesting thing to look at but there is nothing tangible to it as yet. 

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